VICTORY 2026

English

The Power of Music
(One Sh0t)

Lecture – 05

By – Nupur Ma'am



Topics *to be covered*

1. Introduction
2. Overview
3. Stanza's
4. Poetic Device



Topics *to be covered*

5 Theme

6 Important Question and Answer



Topic: Introduction







Topic: Overview

funny

'The Power of Music' is a humorous poem. The poet is talking about a bad and irritating singer named **Bhisma Lochan Sharma.** He sings in such a loud voice that the listeners request him not to sing. Bhisma is adamant on singing which bothers even the plants and animals.

Finally, he is struck by a goat and thus, his singing ends

hell-bent





Topic: Stanza - 1

When summer comes, we hear

the ***hums*** songs

Bhisma Lochan Sharma.

You catch his ***strain*** *on hill and*

plain from Delhi song/music

down to Burma.



Topic: Multiple Choice Question

#Q. Despite their irritation people agree that the song is … .

A harmful

B well-meant

C moralistic

D sensuous



Topic: Stanza-2

He sings as though he's staked his life,

he sings as though he's **hell-bent**;

The people, **dazed**, **retire** **amazed** although they know

it's well-meant.





Topic: Stanza-3

Crushed

They're **trampled** in the **panic rout** or **languish** forced to suffer

pale and **sickly,** ill

stampede (ग़दर)

And **plead**, **'My friend, we're near our end, oh**

(request)

stop your singing quickly! lost your patience

The bullock-carts are overturned, and horses

upside down

line the roadside;

But Bhisma Lochan, unconcerned, goes

booming out his broadside. Continues to sing in a harsh, loud sound



Topic: Multiple Choice Question

#Q. What kind of person was Bhisma Lochan Sharma?

A Pleasant

B Stubborn

C Gentle

D arrogant



Topic: Stanza-4

→ Alliteration

→ Personification
→ Enjambment
Hyperbole.
← (exaggeration)

→ Visual imagery
→ Auditory imagery

The **wretched** **brutes** resent the **blare** the hour

they hear it sounded, They **whine** and stare with feet in air or wonder

quite **confounded.**

The fishes dived below the lake in **frantic** search

for silence,

The very trees collapse and shake - you hear the

crash a mile hence -





Topic: Stanza-5

And in the sky the feathered fly **turn turtle**
while they're winging,
Again we cry, ***'We're going to die, oh won't you***
stop your singing?

birds
B
flying
A
upside down
C
B
A B C B



Turn turtle: an idiomatic expression meaning to tum upside down, usually referring to a boat capsizing.

Topic: Multiple Choice Question

#Q. In what state of mind are the human listeners?

A. cheerful

B. dazed

C. indifferent

D. sullen — bad-tempered



Topic: Stanza-6

reach high (sang so loudly)

But Bhisma's **soared** beyond our reach, howe'er

we **plead** and **grumble**;

The **welkin** **weeps** to hear his **screech**, and **mighty**

mansions **tumble.**

request — Complain in an unpleasant manner — sky — cries — Strongly-built — loud, unpleasant sound — buildings — fall down

A B C B

⇒ Enjambment

+ Hyperbole — Onomatopoeia (sound words)

⇒ Alliteration

⇒ Personification — Screech





Topic: Stanza-6

male goat

But now there comes a **billy goat**, a most

wise

sagacious fellow,

puts down

Hits (attacks)

He downs his horns and charges straight, with

Ref.

throw up in the air

bellow answ'ring bellow.

shout in a loud voice

The strains of song are tossed and **whirled** by

circled

blast of brutal violence,

And Bhisma Lochan grants the world the golden

(Metaphor)

gift of silence.

Onomatopeia ⇒ strain bellow



Topic: Multiple Choice Question

#Q. Which of these collapse on hearing Bhisma's voice?

A. roads

B. building and trees

C. bridges

D. none of the above



Topic: Poetic Device

Read

1. **Hyperbole:** This is **a figure of speech that involves exaggeration for emphasis** or dramatic effect. The poem is filled with hyperbole to create a comic effect and emphasise the power of Bhisma Lochan Sharma's singing.

   Example: ***"The very trees collapse and shake-you hear the crash a mile hence-"***

2. **Alliteration:** Alliteration involves **the repetition of the same initial consonant sounds in words close to each other.**

   Example: ***"Bhisma Lochan, unconcerned, goes booming out his broadside."***



Topic: Poetic Device

3. **Personification:** This literary device **involves giving human characteristics to non-human entities** In the poem, animals, trees, and even the sky (the welkin) are personified.

   Example: ***"The welkin weeps to hear his screech, and mighty mansions tumble."***

4. **Onomatopoeia:** Onomatopoeia **involves the use of words that mimic the sounds** they denote.

   Example: ***"He downs his horns and charges straight, with bellow answ 'ring bellow."***



Topic: Poetic Device

5. **Metaphor:** Metaphors **make an implicit or hidden comparison between two unrelated things.** Here, Bhisma Lochan's song is compared to a powerful force causing chaos, and silence is referred to as a "golden gift.“

Example: ***"And Bhisma Lochan grants the world the golden gift of silence"***

6. **Imagery:** Imagery **involves the use of language to represent objects, actions, or ideas in a way that appeals to our physical senses.** The poem is filled with vivid imagery, describing the impact of the song on the environment.

Example: ***"The fishes dived below the lake in frantic search for silence,"***



Topic: Poetic Device

7. **Rhyme:** The poem uses a consistent *AABB rhyme scheme*, creating a musical effect that mirrors the poem's subject matter.

8. **Simile:** Although not prominently used, there is a simile in the line *"He sings as though he's staked his life,"* comparing Bhisma's passion in singing to someone betting their life on something.



Topic: Themes

1. **The power and impact of music:** As suggested by the title, the primary theme is the profound power that music can hold. Bhisma Lochan Sharma's singing is portrayed as a potent force that impacts everyone and everything around him. His music has the power to disrupt and cause chaos, emphasising how influential sounds can be.

2. **Humour and satire:** The poem uses humour and satire to explore the exaggerated effects of music. The hyperbolic descriptions of the chaos caused by Bhisma Lochan's singing contributes to the comical tone of the poem.

Topic: Multiple Choice Question

#Q. How is the billy goat described in the poem?

A. foolish

B. intelligent

C. silly

D. eccentric → strange

Topic: Competency Based MCQs

#Q. ***"The people, dazed, retire amazed, although they know it's well meant."***
This line tells us that Bhisma Lochan's singing was

A melodious.

B discordant. harsh or jarring

C soothing.

D unbelievable

Topic: Competency Based MCQs

#Q. ***And in the sky the feathered fly turn turtle while they're winging. What does the phrase turn turtle mean?***

A. Act like a turtle.

B. Jump like a turtle.

C. Turn upside down.

D. Become a turtle

Topic: Competency Based MCQs

#Q. What does the phrase "panic rout" imply in the poem The Power of Music?

A. Solemn parade

B. Celebration

C. Unhappy occasion

D. Chaotic situation

Topic: Competency Based Extract Questions

#Q. ***Read the following extract from the poem The Haunted Houses and answer the following question:***

He downs his horns and charges straight, with bellow answ'ring bellow.
The strains of song are tossed and whirled by blast of brutal violence,
And Bhisma Lochan grants the world the golden gift of silence.

Topic: Competency Based Extract Questions

#Q. ***In which season would one hear Bhisma Lochan Sharma singing? Where would one hear his voice?***

Ans: One would hear Bhisma Lochan Sharma singing during summer.
They would hear his voice:

- on the hill.
- on plains from Delhi to Burma.

Topic: Competency Based Extract Questions

#Q. ***Give one reason to conclude that Bhisma was passionate about singing. How did people react when they heard his song?***

Ans: He was not bothered about people's reactions and sang as if his life depended on it.

When people heard his songs, they became: (any two)

- dazed.
- became pale and sickly.
- retired amazed.
- they begged him to stop.

Topic: Competency Based Extract Questions

#Q. ***How did animals react when they heard Bhisma Lochan Sharma?***

Ans: Reaction of the animals:

- the bullock carts overturned.
- horses lined the roadside/they whine and stare with feet in the air.
- the fishes dive below the lake in search of silence.

Topic: Competency Based Extract Questions

#Q. ***After reading the poem, give any three characteristic features that you can associate with Bhisma Lochan Sharma.***

Ans: Characteristic features associated with Bhisma Lochan Sharma:

- determined
- stubborn
- not bothered about others' opinions/ unconcerned

Topic: Competency Based Extract Questions

#Q. ***How did the world get the golden gift of silence? Mention two ways in which music helps a person.***

Ans: According to the poem, the world got the golden gift of silence:

- the goat
- attacked Bhisma Lochan Sharma

Two ways in which music helps: (any two)

- soothes the mind.
- reduces pain and anxiety.
- improves one's cognitive power.

Topic: Competency Based MCQs

#Q. ***Which of the given options contains the figure of speech that appears in the following line from the poem, 'The Power of Music'?***

And in the sky the feathered fly turn turtle while
They're winging,

Allit.

A You're one month on in the middle of May

B Rainbow-tinted circles of light

C And life is too much like a pathless wood

Simile (as, like)

D The wind lies asleep in the arms of the dawn



Homework From Victory 2026 Module

Personif ⇒ givi

walking - sky

Historical Background

Bhishma Lochan Sharma ⇒ The Britishers

Billy Goat ⇒ Freedom Fighters

Rhyme Scheme

star (A)
are (A)
high (B)
sky (B)


Thank You